Players Guide to Atheron

A world guide

Welcome to Atheron: Atheron is a world of ancient secrets and rising storms, where fractured nations, mercantile powers, and forgotten legacies collide. Across its continents, gleaming empires clash with wandering clans, free cities thrive on trade and intrigue, and shadowed cults whisper of powers best left buried. Long ago, a veil was drawn over the past, and the truth of what came before has faded into myth — but the cracks are beginning to show. Chaos storms tear across seas, beasts born of madness stalk the wilds, and the balance of power grows ever more fragile. Whether you raise a sword, wield forgotten magics, or simply try to survive the ambitions of kings and guilds, your story in Atheron will shape the fate of a world teetering on the edge of revelation.

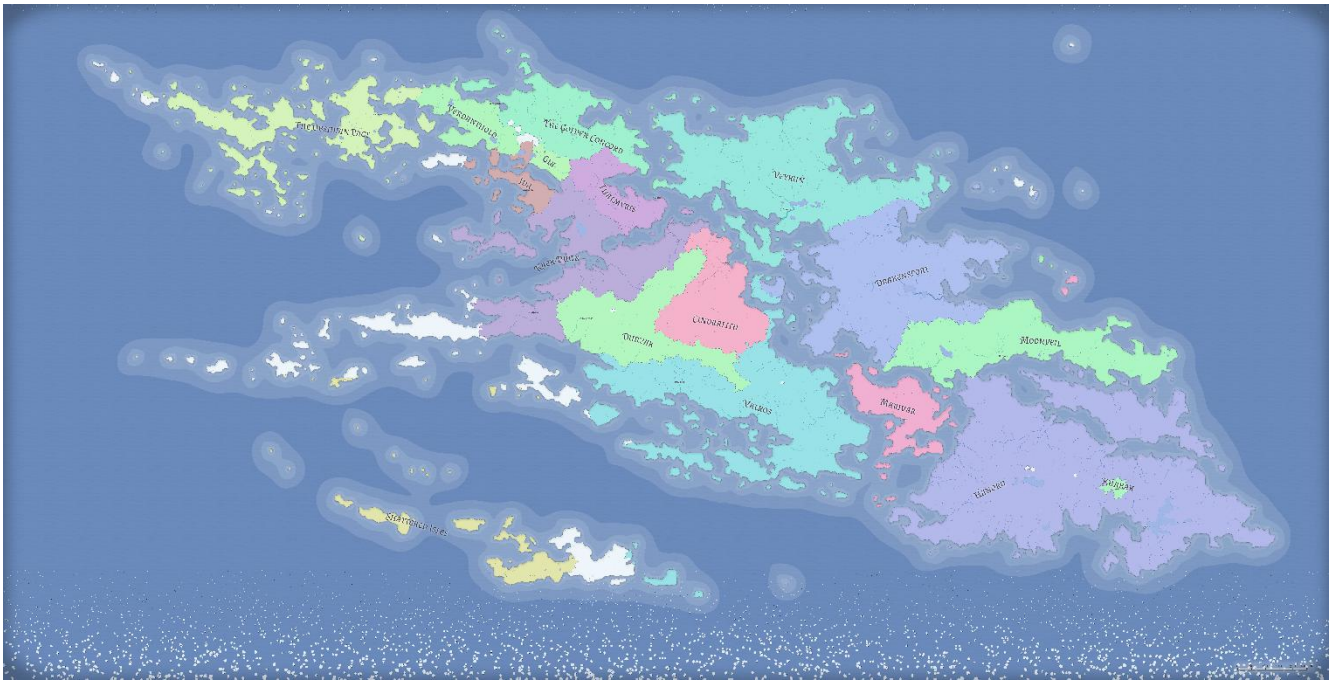
Atheron

The World

Map

The world of Atheron is made up of four major regions.

- Aelyria – The Eastern Continent
- Thandros – The South Continent
- Eryndral – The Northern Continent
- The Duunmarch – The Land Bridge



Nations

Hanoru Shogunate

Capital: Shidome – "The Seat of the Blade," a misty fortress city beneath a sacred mountain.
Nickname: *The City of Ten Thousand Lanterns* – at night, every street glows with paper lanterns.
Leader: Shogun **Takeda Moriyasu**

Succession: Hereditary, but heavily influenced by the Council of Daimyōs. The Shogun's heir must be approved through ritual combat or assassination of rivals, keeping the warrior elite constantly engaged.

Valros Empire

Capital: Imperion – a glittering river-metropolis with fine sandstone buildings.
Nickname: *The Eternal Throne* – seen as the heart of all order and law.
Leader: Emperor **Kaelthar IV**
Succession: Hereditary primogeniture. If no clear heir exists, the High Council selects a successor from the royal family based on martial aptitude.
Notes: Highly militaristic. All citizens are required to do military service or equivalent civilian service.

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Veyrun

Capital: Orkhadar – a great tent-city of yurts and palaces, rebuilt anew wherever the Khan sets camp.
Nickname: *The Moving Capital* – wherever the Khan camps, the empire follows.
Leader: Great Khan **Torgai the Storm-Eagle**
Succession: Meritocratic and violent. At the Khan's death, rival clan leaders fight to claim the title; the winner must be acknowledged by a council of elders and shamans.

Drakensport

Capital: Vyrrathen – ancient keeps built into dragon-bone ruins, with noble banners hanging from every spire.
Nickname: *The Dragon's Shadow* – nobles claim the bones of dragons still sleep beneath the city.
Leader(s): The **Council of Dragon-Bloods** – Twelve noble houses, each claiming descent from dragons. Currently led by Lady **Serenya Veyrath**
Succession: Rotating noble leadership. Each Dragon-Blood house nominates a leader, who serves for ten years or until removed.
Notes: Major trade nation, often competes with the Marivar League

Kingdom of Kaer-Duun

Capital: Stellaris – a city of observatories and crystal towers aligned with constellations.
Nickname: *The Star-Crowned City* – its towers align with the heavens.
Leader: The **Stellar Synod** – A circle of astrologer-priests. Their speaker is High Oracle **Myrran Duskveiler**
Succession: Appointment by the Stellar Synod. High priests are chosen based on astrological signs and omens; no family ties matter.
Notes: They place a high value on magical potential and contains many institutions focused on the study and development of magic.

Durvak

Capital: Gravenforge – a fortress-city carved directly into the heart of a mountain, always echoing with the ring of hammers.
Nickname: *The Anvil of the World* – the earth itself sings with hammers here.
Leader: High Guildmaster Rorek Ironbrand
Succession: Leadership remains within the Ironbrand Guild, usually passing to the eldest skilled heir. If no heir exists, the guild elects a master craftsman from the top-ranking guilds

The Obsidian Pact

Capital: Ashkara – a volcanic citadel where black stone towers glow faintly with infernal runes.
Nickname: *The Black Flame* – its volcanic glow can be seen for leagues.
Leader(s): The **Council of Seven Flames** – a council of sorcerers. Their figurehead is Archmage **Veythar the Ashen**
Succession: Magical ceremonies determine leadership. When a council member dies a new sorcerer must perform a ritual to ascend.
Notes: Very secretive and isolationist. Not open to outsiders.

The Golden Concord

Capital: Hallowmere – a river-port city famed for golden harvest festivals and temple-granaries.
Nickname: *The Granary of the Gods* – its harvests are blessed, its silos like temples.
Leader(s): The **Concord of Elders** – elected peasant-council leaders, balanced by **High Harvester Talmir** of the temple.
Succession: Electoral. Elders of the villages and heads of harvest temples vote for the High Harvester and council members every decade.

Cindralith Theocracy

Capital: Solareth – "City of the Sun," with gleaming white temples that reflect light for miles across the desert.
Nickname: *The City of a Thousand Suns* – mirrors and domes dazzle with reflected light.
Leader: Sun-Priest **Aurelion IX**

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Succession: Chosen by divine visions. A council of priests interprets signs from the sun god, then the chosen priest undergoes a sacred trial.

Holy State of Moonveil

Capital: Noctyra – a hushed, silver-lit city of domes and veils, alive only after sundown.
Nickname: *The Veiled City* – silent by day, silver and alive by night.
Leader: The **Veiled Oracle**
Succession: Hereditary within the secretive line of Veiled Oracles, but each successor must pass the Ritual of the Silver Veil
Notes: Moonveil oracles are renowned globally as the best prophets. Many leaders will seek the service of an oracle in their court.

The Marivar League

Capital: Corsava – a free-port city where merchant-princes gather, its harbor forests of masts and sails.
Nickname: *The Jewel of the Azure Sea* – all trade must pass through its harbor.
Leader(s): The **Council of Captains** – merchant princes who constantly bicker. Currently dominated by Lady **Selvara di Corsava**
Succession: Council-based. Each city-state elects a captain to the Council of Captains; the senior-most member becomes speaker.
Notes: Less of a nation and more of a collection of free cities that have banded together to benefit from shared negotiating power.

The Kingdom of Thalmyris

Capital: Thalmyris – a pearl-white coral city half on land, half rising from the sea.
Nickname: *The Pearl Throne* – half land, half sea, crowned in coral.
Leader: Queen **Nerissa Coralborn**
Succession: Hereditary monarchy. Succession requires the blessing of the Sea Oracle.
Notes: Formerly was the largest power in the northern continent before going to war with Kaer-Duun. The lost caused the succession of Ida and Gia. This defeat has caused the nation to treat mages poorly and all mages here require a state license

The Verdanthold Council

Capital: Eryndralis – a city woven among colossal living trees, glowing with druidic wards.
Nickname: *The Living City* – its walls and halls grow, not built.
Leader(s): The **Circle of Thirteen Druids** – each representing a great spirit of the wild. Their speaker is **Elder Brynn Oakfather**
Succession: Rotating leadership. Each druidic member represents a great spirit and holds authority for life

The Shattered Isles

Capital: Krakenhold – a pirate-ruled stronghold, built on volcanic cliffs with shipwrecks for walls.
Nickname: The Pirate's Crown – every raider dreams of ruling here.
Leader: Pirate-King **Darrik One-Eye**
Succession: Violent pirate elections. Any pirate can challenge the Pirate-King to combat or a sea raid duel. Death or defeat transfers power immediately; the winner claims the crown and the fleet.

The Principality of Ida

Capital: Braemspire – a steel bastion city, its towers crowned with black banners of conquest.
Nickname: *The Iron Bastion* – said to be unbreachable in war.
Leader: Prince **Alaric Braem**
Succession: Hereditary

The Dutchy of Gia

Capital: Calvesset – a pastoral riverside duchy seat, famed for vineyards and stained-glass chapels.

Nickname: *The Garden Duchy* – famous for its vineyards and green valleys.
Leader: Duchess **Isolde di Gia**
Succession: Primogeniture within the ducal family. If no heirs exist, the council of nobles nominates a new ruler

The Kharak Tribes

Capital: Torvashk – a great circle of stone and tent encampments, serving as both holy ground and political moot.
Nickname: *The Circle of Stones* – a sacred meeting place of all clans.
Leader(s): No single ruler—tribes elect a **High Chieftain** at the Great Moot. Currently **Chieftain Varok Blackmane** holds the title
Succession: The Great Moot elects a new High Chieftain from the strongest clan leaders.

The people

There are a variety of people living across Atheron. These range from the kinfolk (Humans, Dwarves, Elves, Gnomes etc) the Wildkin (Tabaxi, Owlin, Leonin) and the Shadowkin (Goblins, Kobolds.) Over time these peoples have come to live in relative peace though those not of the kinfolk are sometimes looked down on by some.

Kinfolk

The Kinfolk are those ancestries most often associated with settled realms, craft, and long traditions. Humans, dwarves, elves, and gnomes all fall into this broad family, sharing a certain familiarity of form and culture. While each has its own ancient legacies, they are bound by their ability to live side by side, to build lasting nations, and to shape the world in ways that endure for centuries. Among the Kinfolk, diversity of thought and ambition is as vast as any other group, but their shared presence in cities, courts, and guildhalls makes them the faces most often seen in positions of influence.

Wildkin

The Wildkin trace their heritage to the untamed places of the world, bearing the features of beasts and birds woven into their very blood. Tabaxi, Owlin, and others like them embody the instincts, grace, and resilience of the wilds, often finding harmony where civilization meets nature. Wildkin come in a variety of shapes and sizes, pure Wildkin share many traits with creatures of the land and sea while hybrid Wildkin may begin to look more like Kinfolk with Wildkin traits. To some, they are wanderers or outlanders, but to themselves they are the living bridge between mortal peoples and the primal spirits of the world. The Wildkin's strength lies not only in claw or wing, but in the deep bond they carry with the earth, sky, and all the creatures that roam them.

Shadowkin

The Shadowkin are peoples often misunderstood, born of twilight realms, hidden caverns, and the forgotten edges of the map. Goblins, kobolds, and similar ancestries thrive in places where light is scarce and survival demands cunning. Though outsiders may call them strange or fearsome, among their own they carry rich traditions, clever artistry, and a fierce loyalty to kin and clan. The Shadowkin walk a path between worlds — feared by some, underestimated by others — but always enduring, adapting, and proving that there is strength in the overlooked and underestimated.

Faith

The world of Atheron worships a core pantheon of the 12 gods. There are other minor gods that may be worshiped or encountered but the 12 represent the pillars of faith.

1. **Grommash, God of War and Valor**
    - **Domains**: Battle, Courage
    - **Symbol**: A crossed sword and axe

- **Description**: Grommash is the embodiment of physical power and martial prowess. He is worshipped by warriors and athletes.

2. **Terra, Goddess of Earth and Endurance**
    - **Domains**: Earth, Resilience
    - **Symbol**: A mountain with a tree rooted at the top
    - **Description**: Terra represents the enduring strength of the earth and nature. Farmers, builders, and those who seek fortitude honor her.
3. **Solara, Goddess of the Sun and Precision**
    - **Domains**: Light, Accuracy
    - **Symbol**: A radiant sun with a bow and arrow
    - **Description**: Solara is the goddess of light and perfect aim, revered by archers and craftsmen.
4. **Lunara, Goddess of the Moon and Agility**
    - **Domains**: Night, Grace
    - **Symbol**: A crescent moon with a dancer
    - **Description**: Lunara embodies the swift and silent movement of the night. Thieves, dancers, and those who value agility worship her.
5. **Vitalis, God of Life and Health**
    - **Domains**: Healing, Vitality
    - **Symbol**: A green leaf with a heart
    - **Description**: Vitalis is the protector of life and health, worshipped by healers and those seeking wellness.
6. **Mortis, God of Death and Decay**
    - **Domains**: Death, Transformation
    - **Symbol**: A skull with a black rose
    - **Description**: Mortis governs the natural end of life and the cycle of decay, respected by those who understand the inevitability of death.
7. **Athara, Goddess of Knowledge and Magic**
    - **Domains**: Arcana, Wisdom
    - **Symbol**: An open book with a glowing orb
    - **Description**: Athara is the source of all knowledge and magical understanding, revered by scholars and wizards.
8. **Tinker, God of Invention and Craft**
    - **Domains**: Craftsmanship, Innovation
    - **Symbol**: A gear with a hammer and quill

- **Description**: Tinker represents the ingenuity and creativity of invention, worshipped by artificers and engineers.

9. **Seren, Goddess of Peace and Serenity**
    - **Domains**: Tranquility, Compassion
    - **Symbol**: A dove with an olive branch
    - **Description**: Seren embodies inner peace and compassionate wisdom, revered by monks and healers.
10. **Tempus, God of Time and Foresight**
    - **Domains**: Time, Prophecy
    - **Symbol**: An hourglass with an eye
    - **Description**: Tempus governs the flow of time and the gift of foresight, honored by seers and those who seek guidance.
11. **Elysia, Goddess of Beauty and Inspiration**
    - **Domains**: Art, Inspiration
    - **Symbol**: A painter's palette with a radiant star
    - **Description**: Elysia inspires beauty and creativity, worshipped by artists, bards, and performers.
12. **Aurelius, God of Leadership and Persuasion**
    - **Domains**: Authority, Influence
    - **Symbol**: A crown with a scepter and laurel wreath
    - **Description**: Aurelius embodies the power of leadership and persuasive speech, revered by rulers, diplomats, and orators.